

Study Brief: *Teens and Pornography* - School-Day and School-Device Findings

Prepared as a concise, sourced PDF summary of the Common Sense Media study that contains the 44% school-issued-device finding. This is not a reproduction of the full copyrighted report.

Core citation

Robb, M. B., & Mann, S. (2023). *Teens and Pornography*. San Francisco, CA: Common Sense.

Official report PDF: <https://www.common sense media.org/sites/default/files/research/report/2022-teens-and-pornography-final-web.pdf>

Official research page: <https://www.common sense media.org/research/teens-and-pornography>

The finding you need

Among teens who had seen pornography during the school day, **44%** said they had seen it on a **school-issued device**. The report states that this represented **13% of all teen respondents**. Reported school-issued-device exposure was highest among ages 13-14; **17%** of respondents in that age group said they had seen pornography on a device issued or owned by their school. Source: report p. 16.

Why the wording matters

The report uses both **school-owned devices** and **school-issued device** language. In the key findings section it says nearly half of teens who viewed pornography during the school day reported viewing it on school-owned devices. In the school section it states that 44% of school-day viewers saw it on a school-issued device, representing 13% of all teen respondents. Sources: report pp. 5 and 16.

Study identity and method

Field	Detail	Source location
Report title	Teens and Pornography	Cover / suggested citation
Authors	Michael B. Robb, PhD, and Supreet Mann, PhD, Common Sense	Report credits, p. i
Data collection	Benenson Strategy Group conducted the quantitative online survey.	Methodology / credits
Sample	N = 1,358 U.S. teens ages 13-17; the sample included n = 1,007 teens exposed to online pornography and n = 259 LGBTQ+ teens.	Report p. 3; press release methodology
Field dates	September 12-21, 2022.	Report p. 3; press release methodology
IRB	Approved by Advarra IRB with additional protections for children as research subjects.	Report p. 3; press release methodology
Design limitation	Cross-sectional, self-reported survey. The report states it was not designed to answer causal questions and that no margin of error can be calculated for the non-probability-based sample.	Report pp. 2-3

Definition used by the report

The report defines online pornography as videos or photos viewed on websites, social media, or elsewhere on the internet showing nudity and sexual acts intended to entertain and sexually arouse the viewer. Source: report p. 2; press release.

Key findings from the report

Finding	Reported value	Notes / source location
Teens who reported consuming / seeing online pornography	73%	Report key findings; press release
First saw online pornography at age 13 or younger	54%	Among all teens; report p. 5 and p. 11
First saw online pornography at age 10 or younger	15%	Among all teens; report p. 5 and p. 11
Average self-reported first exposure	Age 12	Report p. 5 and p. 11
Viewed pornography intentionally	44%	Among all teens; report p. 5 and p. 11
Encountered pornography accidentally	58%	Among all teens; report p. 5 and p. 11
Viewed pornography intentionally in the last week	71%	Among teens who intentionally watched pornography; report p. 5
Felt pornography gives helpful information about sex	45%	Report p. 5; press release
Had discussed pornography with a trusted adult	43%	Report infographic / role of trusted adults section

School-day and school-device findings

School/device finding	Reported value	Interpretive use
Pornography exposure during the school day	30% of all teens; 41% of teens exposed to pornography	Shows this is not only home exposure or private off-campus exposure.
Pornography exposure while physically at school	23% of all teens	Shows the pathway includes in-person school conditions, not only remote learning.
Pornography exposure while attending school remotely	12% of all teens	Shows school-day exposure also appeared during remote-school conditions; report notes the term was not defined.
Frequency among those seeing pornography during the school day	60% several times a month; 40% at least weekly	Shows recurrence, not only one-off accidental exposure.
School-issued-device exposure among school-day viewers	44%	Core device finding: school-day exposure occurred through a school-issued device for nearly half of school-day viewers.
All respondents represented by school-issued-device exposure	13% of all teen respondents	Converts the subset statistic into a whole-sample statistic.

School/device finding	Reported value	Interpretive use
Ages 13-14 school-issued/owned device exposure	17%	Shows the youngest age band in the study had the highest reported school-device exposure.

School type data

For the report's school-day pornography finding, the reported rates by school type were: traditional public 26%, charter/magnet 41%, homeschool 27%, and private/religious 50%. Source: report Table 4, p. 15 and continuation discussion, p. 16.

Source locations to cite

Use	Report location	What it supports
Formal citation	Suggested citation line near front matter	Robb & Mann, 2023; Common Sense Media
Methodology	Report pp. 3-4	N=1,358, age 13-17, online panels, IRB, limitations
General exposure	Report pp. 5 and 11	73%, age of first exposure, intentional/accidental exposure
School-day table	Report p. 15, Table 4	30% school-day exposure; 23% physically at school; 12% remote
School-issued device	Report p. 16	44% of school-day viewers; 13% of all teen respondents; 17% ages 13-14
Causality limit	Report p. 2	Cross-sectional study; not designed to answer causal questions

Precise sentence for your notes

Common Sense Media's *Teens and Pornography* study found a school-day, school-device pathway: 30% of all teen respondents reported seeing pornography during the school day, and among school-day viewers, 44% reported seeing it on a school-issued device, representing 13% of all teen respondents.

What the study proves - and what it does not prove

- It supports that teen pornography exposure is not limited to home or private off-campus conditions.
- It supports that a school-day pathway exists in the study sample.
- It supports that school-issued or school-owned devices appeared in that pathway.
- It supports that younger teens, ages 13-14, reported notable exposure on school-issued/owned devices.
- It does not, by itself, prove that any specific school intentionally caused exposure.
- It does not answer causal questions; the report expressly describes the study as cross-sectional and not designed for causation.

Demand-formation / category-control use

For your category-control argument, the study supplies the device/access evidence. It shows that pornography exposure can occur during the school day and through school-issued devices. The stronger structural use is: when institutions claim device control, filtering, monitoring, acceptable-use rules, and school-day digital management, this evidence prevents the pathway

from being dismissed as only private child conduct.

Clean formulation: **school-day, school-device, pornography-mediated sexual socialization**. The report does not use the term demand formation, but it provides the empirical school-device data that can be paired with academic sexual-socialization research.

Limitations to keep attached

- Non-probability sample: the report states a margin of error cannot be calculated.
- Self-report: responses may be affected by stigma, sensitivity, and misreporting risk.
- Cross-sectional design: useful for scale and experience, not causal proof.
- Remote-school ambiguity: the report says it did not define 'attending school remotely.'
- Device-access ambiguity: the report says it did not ask about electronic device access in general.

Sources

1. Robb, M. B., & Mann, S. (2023). *Teens and Pornography*. Common Sense Media. Official report PDF: <https://www.commonsensemedia.org/sites/default/files/research/report/2022-teens-and-pornography-final-web.pdf>
2. Common Sense Media research page, *Teens and Pornography*: <https://www.commonsensemedia.org/research/teens-and-pornography>
3. Common Sense Media press release, January 10, 2023, methodology and headline findings: <https://www.commonsensemedia.org/press-releases/new-report-reveals-truths-about-how-teens-engage-with-pornography>